

CRIES NEONATAL PAIN SCALE

Postoperative Pain Assessment Tool for Neonates (≥32 Weeks)

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____/____/____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____/____/____ : ____

FIVE PHYSIOLOGICAL & BEHAVIORAL SIGNS

Clinical Parameter	Options & Scoring Criteria	Score
C - Crying Vocal tone and pitch	☐ No cry / Normal cry (0) ☐ High pitched cry, consolable (1) ☐ Inconsolable, continuous cry (2)	[]
R - Requires Oxygen Oxygenation to maintain SpO ₂ >95%	☐ No O ₂ required (SpO ₂ >95% air) (0) ☐ Requires < 30% FiO ₂ to maintain SpO ₂ >95% (1) ☐ Requires ≥ 30% FiO ₂ to maintain SpO ₂ >95% (2)	[]
I - Increased Vital Signs Heart rate and blood pressure above baseline	☐ HR & BP equal/less than preop baseline (0) ☐ HR or BP increased by ≤ 20% of baseline (1) ☐ HR or BP increased by > 20% of baseline (2)	[]
E - Expression (Facial) Facial grimace and muscle tension	☐ Relaxed / neutral expression (0) ☐ Grimace present (brow bulge, eye squeeze) (1) ☐ Grimace and non-purposeful grunt (2)	[]
S - Sleeplessness Sleep-wake cycle in past hour	☐ Continuously asleep / wakes normally (0) ☐ Awakens at frequent intervals (1) ☐ Constantly awake, restless (2)	[]

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: 10 points)

Assessor (RN / License #): _____

CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS

No Significant Pain (0 - 3 points)

Comfortable neonate. Non-pharmacological comfort (swaddling, pacifier, sucrose).

Moderate to Severe Pain (≥ 4 points)

Pharmacological analgesia indicated (paracetamol / IV opioid bolus) plus comfort measures. Reevaluate in 30m.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment